

BE A TOPPER HISTORY BY SARA (THUNDERSTUDY)

Exam-Oriented Comprehensive Study Guide (PYQ Analysis)



Top-Tier "Must-Do" Topics (Highest Probability)

These questions appear in almost every paper. Master these first.

Chapter/Theme	Most Repeated Focus Area	Key Keywords/Concepts to Memorize
Harappan Civilization	Urban Planning & Archaeologists	Drainage system, Citadel vs. Lower Town, Domestic architecture. Names: Cunningham (confusion), Marshall (announcement), Wheeler (stratigraphy).
Vijayanagara	Architecture & Fortification	Mahanavami Dibba (rituals), Virupaksha Temple, Sacred Centre, Fortification walls (7 lines), Agricultural tracts.
Mahatma Gandhi	Salt Satyagraha (Dandi March)	Why salt was chosen, breaking the law, mass mobilization, role of the press (American/European coverage).
Revolt of 1857	Visual Representations & Unity	How Rani Laxmibai is portrayed, Rebel proclamations appealing to Unity (Hindus & Muslims), British repression.
Constitution	Federalism & Language	Three Lists (Union, State, Concurrent), Plea for strong center (Ambedkar/Nehru), Debates on Hindi vs. Hindustani.

CHAPTER-WISE PRIORITY LIST (EXAM-ORIENTED FORMAT)

Section A: Ancient India (The Early Period)

- **Bricks, Beads and Bones (Harappa):** Subsistence Strategies (charred grains, plough models), Craft Production (Nageshwar shell, Shortughai Lapis).
- **Kings, Farmers and Towns:** Inscriptions (importance and limitations like faint letters/missing pieces), 6th Century BCE turning point (Rise of states, iron, coinage).
- **Kinship, Caste and Class:** Patriliney (importance for elite), Marriage (Endogamy vs Exogamy, Polyandry of Draupadi).
- **Thinkers, Beliefs and Buildings:** Sanchi Stupa survival (Begums of Bhopal), Buddhism teachings (Sutta Pitaka) and Sigala.

Section B: Medieval India (The Middle Period)

- **Through the Eyes of Travellers:** Al-Biruni (Caste system, Sanskrit), Bernier (East vs. West, Land ownership, Karkhanas).
- **Bhakti-Sufi Traditions:** Nirguna Bhakti (Guru Nanak, Kabir), Saguna Bhakti (Mirabai), Sufism (Chishti silsila and State relation).
- **An Imperial Capital (Vijayanagara):** High Priority: Fortification (Abdur Razzaq) and Mahanavami Dibba.
- **Peasants, Zamindars and the State:** Ain-i-Akbari (importance/limitations), Village Community (Panchayat, Muqaddam).

Section C: Modern India (The National Movement)

- **Colonialism and Countryside:** Bengal (Permanent Settlement failure, Jotedars vs Zamindars), Rajmahal Hills (Paharias-hoe vs Santhals-plough), Deccan Riots.
- **Rebels and the Raj (1857):** Rumours & Prophecies (cartridges, bone dust), British Suppression (military power/new laws).
- **Mahatma Gandhi & National Movement:** Non-Cooperation (start/end reasons), Quit India mass movement, Sources (letters/autobiographies).
- **Framing the Constitution:** Objectives Resolution (Nehru), Separate Electorates debate (Pocker Bahadur vs Pant).

COMMON QUESTION PATTERNS

- **"Justify the Statement":** Quote-based questions. Tip: Memorize 3-4 bullet points per theme.
- **Source-Based (4 Marks):** Ancient (Sutta Pitaka/Manusmriti), Medieval (Bernier/Al-Biruni), Modern (Ryot Commission/Assembly Debates).
- **Map Work (5 Marks):** Harappan sites (Lothal, Kalibangan), Buddhist sites (Bodh Gaya, Sanchi), 1857 centres (Meerut, Delhi, Jhansi), National Movement (Champaran, Dandi).

EASY-TO-REVISE STUDY PLAN

- **Day 1 (Ancient):** Harappa (Towns & Craft) + Mahabharata (Social). Map: Harappa.
- **Day 2 (Medieval):** Vijayanagara Architecture + Mughal Panchayat. Summaries: Al-Biruni & Bernier.
- **Day 3 (Modern P1):** 1857 Revolt (Causes/Visuals) + Colonialism (Jotedars/Santhals).
- **Day 4 (Modern P2):** Gandhi (Salt March) + Constitution (Federalism). Map: National Movement.
- **Day 5 (Review):** Source-based chapters review (Buddhism, Travelers, Constitution).